

Ardiansyah Ihsan

Islamic philanthropy practitioner and digital fundraising strategist

Fifteen years inside Indonesian non-profit institutions: designing fundraising systems, governing zakat and waqf, mobilising volunteers across 38 provinces, and training the people who run those institutions. Certified Nazhir and Amil; Master of Humanitarian Leadership student, Zakat Foundation Institute.

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Live portfolio website

ardiansyahihsan87-stack.github.io/ardiansyah-ihsan.github.io
Palembang, South Sumatra, Indonesia



01 ABOUT ME

Turning generosity into impact

I am an Islamic philanthropy practitioner from Palembang, Indonesia, with fifteen years inside Indonesian non-profit institutions. I design fundraising systems, help govern zakat and waqf, build volunteer networks, and train the people who run these institutions.

Background

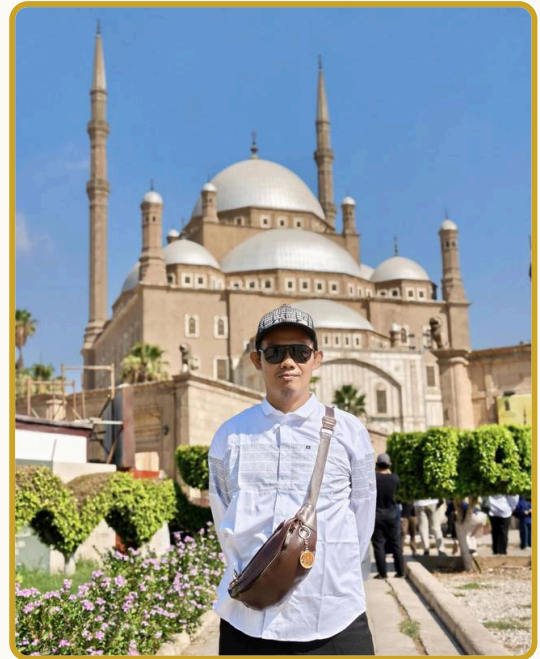
I trained as an English language teacher at Universitas Sriwijaya, but my route into this field was humanitarian and disaster response. There I saw that communities need more than emergency assistance. That path led me to lead a 98-branch national philanthropy network, to serve as Secretary General of Masyarakat Relawan Indonesia, and to found the Digital Fundraising Academy. I am a certified Nazhir and Amil, and I am completing a Master of Humanitarian Leadership at the Zakat Foundation Institute.

What I believe

Generosity in Islam is not merely about giving. It is about building systems that let people help others with dignity, trust, and lasting effect. Philanthropy should not be treated as a fundraising activity; it is a professional ecosystem of trust, resources, people, technology, and impact. An institution's success is not measured by how much money it raises, but by how effectively it converts generosity into sustainable change.

Where I am heading

I am working toward an Islamic philanthropy ecosystem that donors trust, that means something to the people it serves, that draws younger generations in, and that can create impact at scale. In the near term, that means finishing my Master's, continuing my research on legitimacy and digital transparency in zakat governance, and helping more zakat, waqf and mosque institutions become professionally managed without losing their ethical and spiritual foundation.



Cairo, August 2026, during the Gaza relief mission.

"I want to be remembered as someone who turned generosity into impact."

WHAT I WORK ON

- Digital fundraising strategy and channel design
- Zakat and waqf institutional governance
- Organisational capacity building and SOP design
- Volunteer ecosystem development
- Corporate partnership and resource mobilisation
- Cross-border humanitarian response

15

years in Islamic philanthropy

1,000+

practitioners trained

98

branches in a national network led

81,499

volunteers mobilised across 38 provinces

02 RESUME

Experience at a glance

Professional experience

2025 – PRESENT

Founder & Chief Executive Officer*Digital Fundraising Academy*

National capacity-building academy for zakat, waqf and mosque institutions; 1,000+ practitioners trained; long-term institutional consultancy.

PRESENT

General Manager*BaitulMaal Pondok Digital · SIDAQ movement*

Leads the institution behind the SIDAQ Qur'anic philanthropy ecosystem: programme portfolio, fundraising architecture and compliance.

ONGOING

Associate Philanthropy & Institutional Consultant*Satu Amal Indonesia · Rumah Quran Rabbani · Rabithah Peduli*

Restructuring, SOPs, core teams, donor journeys and digital channel architecture.

2020 – 2024

Secretary General*Masyarakat Relawan Indonesia*

Grew a national volunteer society to 81,499 members across 38 provinces; volunteer clustering for specialised deployment.

2017 – 2022

Director of Philanthropy Network*National philanthropy institution*

Led 98 branches; seven philanthropy channels; branch retail fundraising to 40% of the national total.

CONCURRENT

Chief Executive Officer*Relawan Filantropi Indonesia*

Community-based digital philanthropy agent platform: qurban agents, affiliate crowdfunding, digital advocates.

Education

IN PROGRESS

Master of Humanitarian Leadership

Zakat Foundation Institute, Chicago, Illinois, USA (online)

2005 – 2009

Bachelor of Education, English Language Education

Universitas Sriwijaya, Palembang · GPA 3.21 / 4.00

Capabilities

Digital fundraising strategy	Core
Zakat & waqf governance	Core
Capacity building & SOP design	Core
Volunteer ecosystems	Advanced
Humanitarian programme management	Advanced
Qualitative research & writing	Developing

Languages

Indonesian (native) · English (professional)

Full resume: the three-page PDF and the interactive web resume are online.

[Interactive resume](#)

03 WORK & PROJECTS

Selected work



PROJECT 1

Egypt–Palestine Humanitarian Mission

Role: *delegation member, Konsorsium Kebajikan Indonesia* · August 2026

Context. Responding to Gazans affected by the conflict and to Palestinian refugees sheltering in Egypt — people carrying loss, trauma and displacement. The challenge was keeping assistance relevant and dignified, and keeping attention on Gaza after the news cycle moved on.

Process. Coordinated with consortium partners on cross-border logistics, beneficiary verification and accountability; ran food assistance, psychosocial programming for children and Qur'an programming for hafiz students; visited the Palestinian hospital treating evacuated casualties.

5,067

food packages

6

container trucks

14

Indonesian NGOs

Outcome & learning. Humanitarian response is presence and listening as much as distribution. Next time: stronger needs assessment, monitoring of what changed for people, and a longer-term advocacy plan.

LINK [Field deployment](#) [Project page](#)

PROJECT 2

Digital Fundraising Academy

Role: *founder and Chief Executive Officer* · 2025–present

Problem. Zakat institutions, waqf boards and mosque committees were told to go digital without the professional foundations to do it. Training stopped at the seminar, with no change in how institutions ran.

Process. Designed programmes on governance, programme utilisation, sustainability and fundraising management, delivered as webinars, bootcamps and in-house training — then continued as consultancy and long-term mentoring.

1,000+

practitioners trained

3

institutions mentored

Outcome. Consultancy with Satu Amal Indonesia, Rumah Quran Rabbani and Rabithah Peduli on structure, SOPs, core teams and donor network strategy.

LINK [Invited talks](#) [Project page](#)



PROJECT 3

A National Philanthropy Network of 98 Branches

Role: Director of Philanthropy Network · 2017–2022

Problem. A national network is only as strong as its weakest branch. Retail fundraising sat well below potential, and branches worked against targets without shared channels or a common way of engaging donors.

Process. Led the network against fundraising and impact targets, and developed seven distinct philanthropy channels. Much of the work was done branch by branch: mapping donor bases with regional teams and rebuilding their approach.

98

branches

40%

of national retail fundraising

+65%

retail donor engagement

Outcome. The seven-channel structure gave branches a repeatable method rather than a target to improvise against.

LINK [Experience](#) [Project page](#)

PROJECT 4

Building a Volunteer Ecosystem

Role: Secretary General, Masyarakat Relawan Indonesia · 2020–2024

Problem. Volunteer movements grow fast and organise slowly. Without structure, a large volunteer base cannot be matched to the work that actually needs doing.

Process. Grew the network across 38 provinces and 390 districts and cities, and established a clustering system by programme area and profession so skills could be matched to need. Parallel work at Relawan Filantropi Indonesia built a digital philanthropy agent platform.

81,499

volunteers

38

provinces

390

districts & cities

Outcome. A national volunteer society with a structure that made specialised deployment possible.

LINK [Experience](#) [Project page](#)

04 FEATURED CASE STUDY · PROJECT 5

Contested Legitimacy in Indonesian Zakat Governance



Cover of the 15-page case study PDF.

Role: sole researcher and author · Master of Humanitarian Leadership · 2026

Who holds the right to collect and distribute zakat in Indonesia: the state agency, or the private institutions donors trust more? The study argues that what the two sectors really compete for is **legitimacy**.

Process

Qualitative document analysis of nine sources — statute, a 2024 Constitutional Court challenge, two national datasets and recent scholarship — triangulated with three practitioner interviews spanning a state regulator, a national LAZ and a digital-first institution. Inductive coding moved from ~32 codes to four themes.

Findings

- Legitimacy is contested at the level of authority: BAZNAS acts as regulator, auditor and operator at once.
- It is underwritten by trust, which private actors must re-earn through performance.
- It is increasingly earned through *digital legitimacy*: real-time transparency.
- Co-governance stalls because the two sides want different end-states.

Outcome

A legitimacy framework, a conditional co-governance model, and an annotated design prototype for donor-facing transparency.

Read it online: the full PDF is embedded on the portfolio website and can be downloaded.

[Case study page](#) [Case study PDF](#)

12

data sources: 9 documents and 3 practitioner interviews

4

themes, read as facets of a single construct: legitimacy

10

figures, infographics and an annotated wireframe

05 ACHIEVEMENTS & CERTIFICATIONS

Milestones and credentials

98

Branches led nationally

Director of Philanthropy Network, 2017–2022. Branch retail fundraising rose to 40% of the national total; retail donor engagement rose 65%.

81,499

Volunteers mobilised

Secretary General, Masyarakat Relawan Indonesia, 2020–2024, across 38 provinces and 390 districts and cities.

1,000+

Practitioners trained

Through the Digital Fundraising Academy, founded in 2025, with long-term mentoring for three institutions.

5,067

Food packages to Gaza

One of fourteen Indonesian organisations deployed to Egypt with Konsorsium Kebaikan Indonesia, August 2026.

1

Peer-reviewed article

ADL Islamic Economic, 6(1), 2025, plus commentary in *Salaam Gateway* (Türkiye) and *Medium*.

3

Books authored

AMANAH, a reflective memoir on Islamic philanthropy, and two digital fundraising handbooks.

Professional certifications

2026	Certified Nazhir (Waqf Administrator) — National Professional Certification Agency (BNSP) and Indonesian Waqf Board (BWI), July 2026
2025	Certified Amil (Zakat Officer) — BNSP and Sekolah Amil Indonesia, December 2025
2025	Fundraising Essentials — NonprofitReady
2025	Leadership Essentials — DisasterReady
2025	Google Analytics Certification — Google Skillshop
2025	Digital Marketing Certification — HubSpot Academy
2023	Duty of Care for Managers — DisasterReady

RECOGNITION AS A SPEAKER

Invited by Universitas Indonesia's Centre for Islamic Economics and Business, Institut Manajemen Zakat, Global Wakaf, Yayasan Satu Amal Indonesia and Masjid Cendikia, among others.

INTERNATIONAL DEPLOYMENT

Represented the institution in the fourteen-organisation Indonesian delegation for the 2026 Gaza relief mission in Egypt.

06 RESEARCH, WRITING & SPEAKING

Ideas in circulation

Research interests

Legitimacy in zakat governance State-private competition

Digital legitimacy Muslim philanthropy in Southeast Asia

Faith-based humanitarian leadership

Impact measurement in Islamic social finance

Publications & writing

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLE

Ihsan, A. (2025). The impact of the SEHATI programme on interest in applying for halal certification for MSMEs. *ADL Islamic Economic*, 6(1), 98–104.

doi.org/10.56644/adl.v6i1.143

COMMENTARY

"The Contradiction of World Humanitarian Day Celebrations," *Medium*, 2025.

"Reimagining Zakat Management for Greater Impact," *Salaam Gateway Magazine*, Türkiye, 2025.

COURSE RESEARCH

Case study: *Contested Legitimacy in Indonesian Zakat Governance* (2026) · Reflective Book Reviews I–III.

BOOKS

AMANA; *Fundamental Digital Fundraising; Formula Sukses Digital Fundraising*.

Selected invited talks

2026 **The Art of Islamic Digital Fundraising**

Real Masjid, Indonesia

2026 **Mobilising Islamic Philanthropy**

Intermediate Volunteer Class, Yayasan Satu Amal Indonesia

2026 **Content for Masjid**

Bootcamp Cendikia, Masjid Cendikia

2021 **Qurban in the Midst of the Pandemic**

Centre for Islamic Economics and Business, Universitas Indonesia

2021 **Fiqh and Qurban Management**

Institut Manajemen Zakat (IMZ)

2020 **Waqf Building Life**

Global Wakaf, Indonesia

2019 **Disaster Management Basic Training**

Masyarakat Relawan Indonesia, Bengkulu



Teaching the contrast at the centre of my work: a society structured around interest, against one structured around giving.

07 CONTACT

Let's work together

Open to collaboration on Islamic philanthropy, humanitarian programming, institutional development and research partnerships.

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Palembang, South Sumatra, Indonesia



Ardiansyah Ihsan

Scan to open the live portfolio, the interactive resume and the full case study.

Portfolio PDF · September 2026